Q+A

Travel, Reimagined

Actor-producer Richa Chadha's upcoming YouTube travel show,* Musafiri, *is a deep dive into cities



Q. This is an idea that's been percolating for some time, hasn't it?

About eight years. During my maternity break, I was itching to act but couldn't, so I started working on this. I began thinking about what the world and Mumbai would look like when my daughter grows up. My gaze in the show is full of empathy and hope, but there is also grief because our cities are changing so much, so quickly. *Musafiri* is an attempt to build a repository of sorts for future generations.

Q. How would you describe it?

It's all about people, places and lots of *pyaar*. Every season on the show will focus on one city. Over eight episodes, the first season is centred on Mumbai. My quest was to look at the city as a living, ever-evolving space through a post-colonial lens. In college, I majored in history but until now I had never had the opportunity to apply it. Apart from hosting and producing the show, I have also written it.

Q. What was it like rediscovering the city you call home?

During ideation, I did wonder if the first season should be set in Delhi, where I grew up, or maybe Amritsar, where I was born. I settled on Mumbai because I have lived here longer than in any other city. It was fascinating to discover how something that happened in 1566 has impacted our cosmopolitan demographic in 2026; or how the Koli women and local trains have shaped the lives of Mumbai's women.

Q. What is your travel style?

It depends on whether I am travelling alone or with Ali [Fazal, husband] or family. When solo, I pick unusual destinations like Kazakhstan and just explore. If I am in an urban destination and with others, there is also a list of museums. If we are headed to the mountains or forests, it's all about slow and sustainable travel.

—with Karishma Upadhyay